

Merijn Kersten

Creative technologist — building things that survive outside the demo room.

info@merijnkersten.nl merijnkersten.nl Utrecht, NL in/merijn-kerstengah/m-kersten



PROFILE — 9+ YEARS IN XR

As an XR developer I've contributed with a lot of enthusiasm to projects across AR, VR, mobile games and interactive installations. Connecting the virtual and physical world — and my drive to explore the edges of what technology can do — are central to my work. Every project is another chance to give people a fresh perspective.

EXPERIENCE

2025-07 — now

XR consultant & networking engineer

Marechaussee · Apeldoorn, NL

Defence — Unity · C# · VR · Multiplayer networking

The Marechaussee is the Dutch military police. I work on connecting VR players inside a complex training system that has been in development for years — multiplayer networking where failure isn't an option.

2024-11 — 2025-07

XR & AI engineer

Philips · Eindhoven, NL

Health care — Unity · C# · VR · Vision Pro · Blender

Back at the immersive lab: pushing new spatial tech toward something dependable enough to actually be useful, including research into how Apple Vision Pro could be applied within Philips. The freedom to test new techniques and judge whether they hold real value made this the most instructive part of my recent years.

2024-06 — 2024-11

XR engineer

Alliander · Arnhem, NL

Energy — Unity · HoloLens · UWP · Azure & AWS · Figma · WebGL

For Alliander I built HoloLens software that lets field crews enrich their surroundings with information from the grid database, making the construction of medium-voltage stations more efficient. I was responsible for the development, optimisation and UX of these apps, alongside innovation projects like visualising entire neighbourhoods through 3D scanning. Alliander taught me that complex applications demand knowledge from many angles — finding the KPIs that matter and deciding who to involve was an interesting challenge in itself.

2024-03 — 2024-06

XR & AI engineer

Philips · Eindhoven, NL

Health care — Unity · C# · VR · iOS · Blender

At Philips' immersive lab I visualised medical equipment and built VR experiences that are both educational and informative — used to familiarise people with new medical developments and to present them at trade fairs.

2022-01 — 2024-02

Creative technologist

Wonderment · Amsterdam, NL

Immersive reality — Unity · Lightship VPS · Cesium · Node.js · Firebase · Python · PyTorch · WebGL

I joined Wonderment to follow my enthusiasm for AR, building location-based experiences: visualisations, games and web applications, plus R&D into image recognition with machine learning in Unity and Lens Studio. My biggest focus was VPS and Cesium — technology that pins AR to the outside world with centimetre accuracy — enriching environments with geodata like GIS, 3D map tiles and geoJSON. I'm especially proud of leading the development of a multiplayer race game and a photo installation for Niantic: a constant balance between testing risky techniques and hitting deadlines, a challenge I took on with pleasure.

2020-06 — 2022-05

Game developer

Popcore · Berlin, DE

Casual games — Unity · ECS · CI/CD · UI & UX · Blender

Looking for a new challenge I joined Popcore to build hyper-casual games for a huge Android and iOS audience. I ran live-ops on titles like Parking Jam, Pull the Pin and Wrecking Ball, and implemented new game modes, multiplayer features and tools for editors and level designers — everything on an ECS framework for speed and flexibility. Popcore is where I grew fastest as a developer: a place that challenges you to keep sharpening yourself to make games that actually perform in the crowded mobile market.

2019-03 — 2020-03

App developer (freelance)

Zwijzen · Tilburg, NL

Publishing — Unity · AR · iOS · Android

As a freelancer for publisher Zwijzen I built AR seek-and-find and audiobook apps for children's books — designed, developed and published from A to Z on Zwijzen's store pages. The apps were opened through QR codes in the books and gathered tens of thousands of downloads with exclusively positive reviews.

2019-01 — 2020-07

XR & app developer

DTT · Amsterdam, NL

Digital agency — Unity · VR & AR · iOS · Android · HLSL · Shader Graph · WebGL

At DTT I started as an intern and grew into helping lead a team of developers across VR, Android, iOS and web projects. My responsibilities included selecting and mentoring new developers, improving the team's ways of working, and building features like deep linking, iOS plugins, XR, multiplayer, in-app purchases and optimisation.

2016-09 — 2018-09

VR developer

Letink Design · Enter, NL

Immersive reality — Unity · VR & AR · Blender · After Effects

My developer career began at Letink Design, building VR and AR applications for the construction sector, tourism and government — publishing them online and supporting clients on location at trade fairs and events. On the side I made explainer animations, built interactive installations and assembled the office PCs myself.

EDUCATION

2014-10 — 2019-06

Creative media & game technology

Saxion · Enschede, NL

Studied game development across individual and group projects: games, web applications, interactive installations and 3D. For my graduation project I researched AR-framework compatibility through cloud anchors and built my own framework integrating ARCore and ARKit — before ARFoundation existed.

2017-01 — 2017-08

Minor — indie game development

OAMK · Oulu, FI

Led a team building an indie game telling the story of the Sámi, the last tribe of Europe — guiding the project through every round and winning first place for the year.

CERTIFICATES

Unity Certified Professional — Programmer

STACK

Unity · C# · ECS
AR — ARKit · ARFoundation · Lightship VPS
VR — Quest · Vision Pro · HoloLens
JavaScript · TypeScript · React · Node.js
Python · computer vision · AI & LLMs
Firebase · AWS · CI/CD
Blender · Figma

LANGUAGES

Dutch — native
English — fluent

OFF THE CLOCK

Music production, baking, cooking,
history, fitness